

ISLAMIC HISTORY (PART 2)

A Journey from Vicegerent to
Nfs e Mutmayinna... 😊!

Segment: 4

Umayyad Caliphate (661–750)

- Established by Hazraat muaviya, relative of Hazrat Uthman and governor (*wali*) of Syria.
- Hazrat Muiawiyah was an able administrator.
- He was equipped with the much-valued quality of HILM which may be defined as "civilized restraint" and which he himself once described in these words:

- “I apply not my sword where my lash suffices, nor my lash where my tongue is enough. And even if there be one hair binding me to my fellowmen, I do not let it break: when they pull I loosen, and if they loosen I pull.”
- The caliphate was changed into a hereditary office.
- The caliphs lowered the taxes wherever they established their government.

- They provided greater local autonomy (to their delegated governors).
- They provided greater religious freedom to the local Jews and Christians.
- They brought peace to people who were fed up of their local rulers.

- They conquered many new territories like North Africa, Spain, parts of India and central Asia
- It became the largest empire in the world and the fifth largest empire in the history. Its covered area was 5.17 million square miles (13,400,000 km²).
- They made new Arabic coinage replacing imitations of byzantine and sāsānian coins.

- They constructed famous buildings like the Dome of the Rock at Jerusalem, and the Umayyad Mosque at Damascus.
- Arabic became the official state language replacing the regional languages.
- They reorganized the financial administration of the empire by replacing Persian and Greek officials with Arabs

- They introduced a regular post service from Damascus to the provincial capitals.
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- They shifted the capital from medina to Damascus.
 - They cleaned and reopened the canals that irrigated the Tigris-Euphrates Valley which resulted in the prosperity of Area.

They divided the empire into several provinces to be governed by governor appointed by the caliph.

- They were not universally supported within the Muslim community for two reasons:
 - They were not elected by shura.
 - Some of the rulers had impious behavior.

- After the shahadat of Hazrat Husain in Karbala in 680 A.H the banu hashim and the supporters of Hazrat Ali united to bring down the Umayyad's in 750 AH.
- As a result the Abbasids who were from Muhammad's uncle, Abbas bin Abdulmutalib and not from Ali; succeeded .

Reasons of Decline of ummyad's Dynasity

- 1. Incapable rulers viz ; Yazidi and Marwan2
- 2. Indulgence in luxuries, misuse of wealth , ease of loving life and slave girls
- 3. Tribal jealousy, Hejaz Arabs and Yamani

- 4. Resentment in Khorasan, Abbasid movement secretly sparked and marwan2 defeated
- 5. ~~Discrimination against non Arabs, they were not given social and economic equality~~
- 6. hereditary monarchy ; successors
- 7. tragedy of karbala and other insane of Yazid 1

Abbasid Caliphate in Baghdad (750–1258)

- In 750, the Umayyad dynasty was overthrown by a family of Meccan origin, the Abbasids.
- The Abbasids ruled for over three centuries without any break from Baghdad.
- They consolidated Islamic rule.

- In 1261, the Baghdad was devastated by the Mongols.
- The capital was shifted to Egypt.

Abbasid Caliphate in Cairo (1261–1517)

- To protect their caliphate the Abbasids created an army of slave origin known as Mamluks in the 9th century.
- Creation of this foreign army and shifting of the capital from Baghdad to Samarra (IRAQ) by al-Mu'tasim made the peoples against the caliphate.

- The Mamluks steadily grew until they constrained al-Radi (934–41) to hand over most of the royal functions to Mahommed bin Raik.
- After the the devastation of Baghdad at the hands of the Mongols in 1261 the Mamluks of Egypt re-established the Abbasid caliphate in Cairo.

- The Abbasid caliphate of Cairo lasted until the time of Al mutawikkil III who ruled as caliph from 1508 to 1516.
- The Ottoman sultan Selim I defeated the Mamluk Sultanate, and made Egypt part of the Ottoman Empire in 1517.

Fatimid Caliphate (909–1171)

- The Fatimid dynasty was established in North Africa during the period of the Abbasids in 909.
- The founder was Ubaidullah Almahdi Billah.
- It was basically an Ismaili Shia caliphate.

- He claimed descent from Hazrat Muhammad (pbuh) through his daughter Fatima.
- Initially they controlled Algeria, Tunisia and Libya. Then they conquered Egypt and Palestine.
- They built the city of Cairo in 969.

- It was a rare period in history in which the Caliphate went to the descendants of Hazrat Ali (hence the name Fatimid, referring to Ali's wife Fatima) excepting the final period of the Rashidoon caliphate under Hazrat Ali himself.

- They exercised religious tolerance towards
non-Ismaili sects of Islam as well as jews and christains.
- They were then confined to Egypt by the Abbasid dynasty.
- The Fatimid dynasty finally ended in 1171.

Umayyad Caliphate of Córdoba (750–1031)

It was established by Abdur Rehman I a member of the Ummayyad family in 756 in Spain.

- Spain was an integral province of the Umayyad Caliphate ruling from Damascus.

- The Umayyads lost the position of Caliph in Damascus in 750 and Abdur Rehman I a member of the Ummayad family fled to Córdoba in 750.
- He defeated the existing rulers of Abbasids in the area and assumed the title "emir" or "sultan" .
- They used the title "emir" or "sultan" until the 10th century.

- In order to face invasion by the Fatimids
- Abd `ar-Rahman III claimed the title of caliph himself `which helped him in gaining prestige and repulsing the Fatimids.
- They flourished technology, trade and culture.
- They constructed masterpieces in al-andalus.
- It fragmented into various small emirats.

Almoahid Caliphate in Morroco

(1147–1269)

- The Almohad Caliphate الموحدون "the unifiers") was a Moroccan Berber movement founded in the 12th century.
- It was started by Ibn Tumarat (أبو عبد الله محمد ابن تومرت) among the Masmuda tribes of southern Morocco.

- The Almohads first established a Berber state in Tinmel in the Atlas mountain in 1120.
- They succeeded in overthrowing the ruling Almoravids المرابطون governing Morocco by 1147.

- Then Abdul Mumin Algumi (1130-1163) conquered Marrakesh and declared himself Caliph.
- They then extended their power over to all Maghrib by 1159. They then conquered Alandalus.
- And finally all Islamic Iberia(Spain) was under Almohad rule by 1172.
- The last representative of the line was Idris Alwasiq who was reduced to the possession of Markish where he was murdered by a slave in 1269 and thus their Caliphate came to an end.

Ottoman Caliphate (1453–1924)

- The **Ottoman Caliphate** inherited the caliphate from the Abbasids of Egypt.
- It began with Sultan Mehmood.
- His grandson Salim conquered and unified the Muslim lands and became the defender of the holiest places in Islam.

- The demise of the Ottoman Caliphate took place in part because of a slow erosion of power in relation to Europe.
- End of the state took place as result of partitioning of the Empire.
- Abdul Hamid II held the Khalifa position for a couple of years, but with Mustafa Kemmal Ata Turk 's reforms, the caliph position was abolished.